Teacher and cover plan — Recording an exhibition: three visual moments

Pathway: SUMMIT · Week 6 Part 1 · Big question: How do we capture rapid observational sketches, spatial notes, and lighting analyses from curated artworks?

Learning goals and studio kit

• Use your Week 5 Gallery inquiry Sheet to record three distinct visual moments from the curated exhibition collection.

• Capture (1) a spatial & lighting sightline sketch, (2) a 5-value compositional tonal map, and (3) a close-up material execution study.

• Annotate your field sketches with live analytical observations on scale, texture, and audience mood.

Studio kit: Week 5 prepared Gallery inquiry sheets on clipboards, curated exhibition stations (mounted relief/identity works + directional lamps), 2B/4B/6B graphite, fineliners

Arrival and starter

Arrival: Today our studio is set up as a curated gallery with lit exhibition stations. Why are three focused 6-minute field sketches better than staring at one corner for 30 minutes?

Starter question: When making a 6-minute field sketch in front of an exhibited artwork, what should you prioritise?

Teacher model (I do)

Step 1: Capture moment 1 (Spatial & Lighting sketch): At station A, I sketch the relief panel on its easel, drawing directional arrows for the 25-degree top-left lamp and shading the deep cast shadows.

Step 2: Capture moment 2 (5-Value tonal Map): At station B, I half-close my eyes and block in the five tonal values showing how the bright central motif separates from the dark ground.

Step 3: Capture moment 3 (Surface close-up & Notes): I look closely on a laminated gusset joint, transcribe the embossed rivet texture, and annotate how the patina creates aged weight.

Practice routes (Supported / Independent / Aspire)

Supported: Three station sketches (space, tone, texture) and observation notes completed on clipboard.

Independent: Three timed observational studies and live answers to inquiry questions completed.

Aspire: Three visual moments plus comparative dialogue sketch and curatorial thesis completed.

TA and cover notes

TA focus: Set up three clear 'Exhibition stations' around the room featuring mounted relief and identity exemplars lit by angled desk lamps so pupils have authentic gallery stations to sketch.

Staff prep: Staff preparation only: review how to set up classroom gallery stations with directional lamps for live 6-minute field sketching.